

Grammar Mastery - Day 1

7 original questions | Reading and Writing

Complete the questions before turning to the answer explanations. Mark any guess, even if it turns out to be correct. For math, show your setup and check the requested quantity. For reading, identify the exact supporting detail; for grammar, identify the clause or subject.

These questions were authored for this workbook from the lesson topics. They are not official SAT questions or copies of the course's paid practice.

Identifying Independent Clauses | 7 questions

[Lesson video: Identifying Independent Clauses](#)

1. Which option is a complete independent clause?

- A) Although the telescope recorded a faint signal
- B) Recording a faint signal from a distant star
- C) The telescope recorded a faint signal
- D) To record a faint signal from a distant star

2. "The collection of letters from the expedition _____. " Which choice makes a complete sentence?

- A) revealing an unexpected friendship
- B) to reveal an unexpected friendship
- C) which revealed an unexpected friendship
- D) reveals an unexpected friendship

3. Which word is the finite main verb? "Determining whether the fragments belonged to the same vessel required careful analysis."

- A) Determining
- B) belonged
- C) required
- D) analysis

4. Which option is a complete independent clause?

- A) That the seedlings survived the drought surprised the researchers
- B) Because the seedlings survived the drought
- C) The seedlings surviving the drought
- D) Which seedlings survived the drought

5. "The researchers, comparing photographs taken decades apart, _____. " Which choice makes a complete sentence?

- A) documenting a decline in ice cover
- B) documented a decline in ice cover
- C) who documented a decline in ice cover
- D) to document a decline in ice cover

6. Which statement about this sentence is correct? "The archivist is organizing the papers and cataloging the photographs."

- A) It is incomplete because both action words end in -ing.
- B) It is complete because it forms a finite verb phrase with the coordinated participles.
- C) It needs a comma before and.
- D) It has no subject.

7. "Near the entrance to the underground chamber _____. " Which choice makes a complete sentence?

- A) a series of carved symbols
- B) standing several stone pillars
- C) stand several stone pillars
- D) which several stone pillars surround

Answers & explanations

Count correct answers, but also review correct guesses. Redo missed questions after a day without looking at the solution.

1: C 2: D 3: C 4: A 5: B 6: B 7: C

Why each answer works

1. Answer: C. The telescope is the subject and recorded is a finite predicate. Although makes A dependent; B and D lack a finite predicate.

2. Answer: D. The sentence needs a finite predicate for collection. Reveals provides it; the other options create modifiers or infinitive phrases.

3. Answer: C. The gerund phrase beginning Determining is the subject. Required is its finite predicate. Belonged is inside the embedded whether clause.

4. Answer: A. The nominal that-clause is the subject of surprised. A sentence beginning with that can be complete; the outer syntax matters.

5. Answer: B. The comparing phrase is a modifier. Documented supplies the finite predicate needed by researchers.

6. Answer: B. Is organizing and cataloging is a finite coordinated verb phrase. An -ing form can be part of a complete predicate with an auxiliary.

7. Answer: C. An inverted clause follows the location phrase: stand is the finite verb and several stone pillars is the subject.

For each missed or guessed question, record the skill, the condition you overlooked, and one specific action for next time.